

Economic value of the global cycle factor -- timing a 10Y global bond portfolio

Strategy	Mean (%)	Vol (%)	Sharpe	CER, gamma=5 (%)	CER, gamma=10 (%)
GCF-timed	3.10	7.69	0.40	1.62	0.15
Recursive-mean timing	2.47	6.77	0.36	1.32	0.17
Buy-and-hold	2.27	6.74	0.34	1.14	0.00

Real-time strategy, 2005–2024 (n=221 months, asset OOS R2 = 0.13).
Mean–variance exposure w propto $E\hat{\alpha}[r_x]/\sigma\hat{\alpha}^2$ from the recursive GCF_oos forecast (doubly out-of-sample). The Sharpe ratio is scale-invariant; mean, volatility and CER are reported at equal average exposure so the variance penalty is comparable. CER is the annual certainty equivalent of a mean–variance investor. Returns are local-currency excess returns; overlapping 12m returns.